PassFrame
TUITION

Strange Creatures of a Far-off Island

Year 5 — 11+ Mark Scheme (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension · Mark Scheme

For tutor use. Accept any well-reasoned answer supported by evidence from the extract, even if it differs from the wording below.

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

1. A journal or diary entry.

2. Larger than any tortoise described in the scientific journals at home.

3. “it regarded us with a slow, unhurried curiosity, entirely unafraid.”

4. “patterned like the bark of an ancient tree.”

5. That it moved calmly and without rushing.

6. False — they dived into the sea to feed.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. they had never learned to fear humans, having lived without predators.

8. A tortoise, lizards, and birds.

9. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. because lizards are usually associated with land, not the sea.

10. That isolated places develop in unusual, unpredictable ways.

11. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. a journal feels personal and immediate, capturing the writer’s genuine astonishment.

12. Accept a reasoned opinion either way, e.g. probably not, if humans have since visited and disturbed it.

Homework Worksheet — Answers

1. 12th March.

2. Two companions.

3. “strange, spiny creatures that dived without hesitation into the crashing surf to feed on seaweed.”

4. “he had never heard of a lizard that chose the sea over the land, and I confess I shared his astonishment.”

5. Very surprising or remarkable.

6. Correct order: the ship anchors offshore → the writer studies the birds → the writer observes the lizards → the writer fills a notebook with notes.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. without predators, the animals never learned that humans or other creatures were dangerous.

8. Brown and grey, compared to the bark of an ancient tree.

9. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. the evidence of the day convinced her that isolated places behave very differently.

10. That island wildlife can be surprising and hard to generalise about.

11. “remarkable” or “astonishing.”

12. Accept any reasoned personal opinion.